University of St.Gallen

Course and Examination Fact Sheet: Spring Semester 2026

8,598: Real Estate Transaction and Negotiation Strategies

ECTS credits: 4

Overview examination/s

(binding regulations see below)
decentral - Written examination, Digital, Individual work individual grade (100%, 4320 mins.)
Examination time: Term time

Attached courses

Timetable -- Language -- Lecturer
8,598,1.00 Real Estate Transaction and Negotiation Strategies -- English -- Szumilo Monika , Wiegelmann Thomas , Szumilo Nikodem

Course information

Prerequisites

None.

Learning objectives

After completing the module, students will be able to:

1. **Explain** the main real estate asset classes, deal types (asset vs share vs portfolio and forward commitments), and where transaction management fits in the investment process.
2. **Map** different **investor archetypes** (hard-money institutional investors, investment intermediaries, direct private investors, developers) to their mandates, constraints, and negotiation styles.
3. **Describe and analyse** each stage of a real estate investment process (sourcing, screening, due diligence, financing, closing, post-transaction asset management) and identify key transaction costs and frictions.
4. **Apply negotiation theory** (e.g., BATNA, ZOPA, Harvard concept) to real estate transactions, including bilateral and structured bidding processes.
5. **Discuss entrepreneurial and M&A perspectives** in real estate asset management, including strategic motivations of buyers and sellers, deal structuring, and post-merger integration.

Content

The course content is divided into twelve modules that cover the following topics:

- Module 1: **Investment process & transaction economics**
- Module 2: **Investing and building an international portfolio**
- Module 3: **Real estate data: insight, limitations, and practice**
- Module 4: **Forecasting in real estate**
- Module 5: **Investor archetypes in practice**
- Module 6: **From archetypes to deal structure**
- Module 7: **Negotiation concepts tailored to real estate**
- Module 8: **1-to-1 purchase price negotiation**
- Module 9: **Sales processes & negotiation tactics**
- Module 10: **Hamburg Development Case (process & counterparties)**
- Module 11: **Entrepreneurship & M&A in investment and asset management**
- Module 12: **Dr. Rainer Suter on mega trends + assessment overview.**

Structure and indications of the learning and teaching design

Contact hours (on-campus teaching): 18 hours

- 6 teaching days × 2 sessions × 90 minutes = 18 hours

Preparation and follow-up work: 42 hours

- Pre-reading for sessions, reviewing materials, and case study preparation

Case work and group exercises: 24 hours

- Hamburg Development Case, negotiation role-plays, group exercises during and between sessions

Independent study and exam preparation: 28 hours

- Consolidating concepts, preparing for the take-home exam, and additional reading

Literature

1. **Course Materials:**
   Course materials include all lectures, exercises, and self-study materials.
2. **Mandatory literature:**

David M. Geltner, Norman G. Miller, Jim Clayton, Piet Eichholtz (Cengage)

Commercial Real Estate Analysis and Investments.

Andrew E. Baum (Routledge), Real Estate Investment: A Strategic Approach

Roger Fisher, William Ury, Bruce Patton (Penguin)

Getting to Yes: Negotiating Agreement Without Giving In.

3. **Additional literature (recommended):**

Garmaise, Mark J., and Tobias J. Moskowitz. “Confronting Information Asymmetries: Evidence from Real Estate Markets.” *The Review of Financial Studies* 17, no. 2 (2004): 405–37.

Wiegelmann T, Falcão H (2024), "Practice Briefing: A comprehensive negotiation framework for real estate professionals (Part I)". *Journal of Property Investment & Finance*, Vol. 42 No. 6 pp. 591–603, doi:

Additional information

None.

Examination information

Examination sub part/s

1. Examination sub part (1/1)

Examination modalities

Examination type	Written examination
Responsible for organisation	decentral

Examination form	Written exam
Examination mode	Digital
Time of examination	Term time
Examination execution	Synchronous
Examination location	Off Campus
Grading type	Individual work individual grade
Weighting	100%
Duration	4320 mins.

Languages
Question language: English
Answer language: English

Remark
Take-home exam to be solved in 72 hours

Examination-aid rule
Open Book

Students are free to choose aids, apart from the following restrictions:

- pocket calculator models which are not part of the Texas Instruments TI-30 series, as well as any programmable electronic devices that are capable of communication such as electronic dictionaries, notebooks, tablets, smartphones, headsets, additional screens, etc. are not admissible;

- there is an option for faculty members to explicitly define exceptions under supplementary aids.

Procuring any aids, as well as ensuring their working order, is the exclusive responsibility of students.

Supplementary aids

Comprehensive case-based exam (72 hours, 3,500-4,000 words) centered on a realistic multi-asset portfolio transaction. Students act as transaction advisors and must: (1) analyze competing investor archetypes and develop a differentiated strategy, (2) map the investment process and identify key due diligence priorities and transaction frictions, (3) apply data analysis and AI-augmented forecasting to assess risks and support valuation, and (4) design a negotiation strategy for a structured bidding process using BATNA/ZOPA analysis and tactical considerations. The exam integrates all learning objectives and tests students' ability to synthesize theory with practical judgment under realistic constraints.

Content
- Lecture
- Exercises
- Independent studies
- Mandatory literature

Literature

The lecture materials, exercise materials, and independent studies.

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Please note

Please note that only this fact sheet and the examination schedule published at the time of bidding are binding and takes precedence over other information, such as information on StudyNet (Canvas), on lecturers' websites and information in lectures etc.
Any references and links to third-party content within the fact sheet are only of a supplementary, informative nature and lie outside the area of responsibility of the University of St.Gallen.

Documents and materials are only relevant for central examinations if they are available by the end of the lecture period (CW21) at the latest. In the case of centrally organised mid-term examinations, the documents and materials up to CW 13 (Monday, 23rd March 2026) are relevant for testing.

Binding nature of the fact sheets:

- Course information as well as examination date (organised centrally/decentrally) and form of examination: from bidding start in CW 04 (Thursday, 22nd January 2026);
- Examination information (supplementary aids, examination contents, examination literature) for decentralised examinations: in CW 12 (Monday, 16 March 2026);
- Examination information (supplementary aids, examination contents, examination literature) for centrally organised mid-term examinations: in CW 14 (Monday, 30 March 2026);
- Examination information (regulations on aids, examination contents, examination literature) for centrally organised examinations: two weeks before ending with de-registration period in CW 15 (Monday, 06 April 2026).